TEXT TYPE · B2 · LONG OR SHORT TASK

The report

Present findings and recommend action

Word count	Register	Title	Structure
~250 or ~400 words	**Formal and neutral**	**Subject line + section headings**	**Header + 5 sections**

STRUCTURE AND LAYOUT

Date: – [date]
From: – [your name / role]
Subject: – [clear, descriptive title]
Introduction – ~50–80 words – state purpose and data source
Section + heading – ~40–60 words – content point 1, under its own heading
Section + heading – ~40–60 words – content point 2, under its own heading
Section + heading – ~40–60 words – content point 3, often the recommendations
Conclusion – ~30–40 words – short summary, no new facts

DO'S AND DON'TS

DO

- Present and analyse facts; save your own view for the recommendations
- Be neutral and keep to the point
- Use the passive voice where appropriate
- Include specific data when referencing surveys/statistics – you may invent realistic figures
- End with clear recommendations or suggestions
- Make the layout clear: headings and short sections
- Use a range of linking words

DON'T

- Don't give personal opinions in the main body
- Don't repeat information across sections
- Don't write anything that isn't relevant
- Don't forget the Date / From / Subject header
- Don't forget section headings
- Don't use emotional or informal language

WEAKER VS. STRONGER

WEAKER

I really think the school canteen is terrible and nobody likes it.

STRONGER

Key findings: 68 per cent of the 120 students surveyed rated the canteen food as poor or very poor.

Why it matters. A report stays factual and presents its evidence under meaningful headings. Personal outbursts cost you marks because the register is wrong.

KEY TIP

You can recognise a report at a glance because of its headings. Give every section a meaningful heading (for example "Key findings"). You do not need to number them.

MODEL TEXT

Survey Results – Student Stress Levels (~250 words · Formal register)

> **The task.** The student council has carried out a survey on stress among students in years 5 and 6. Write a report for the head teacher.
>
> In your report you should:
>
> - present how stressed students feel
> - explain the main causes of stress
> - recommend measures the school could take
>
> Write around 250 words. The model follows the five-paragraph plan: introduction, one paragraph for each content point, conclusion.

Structure Content Language Text-specific

Date: 15 March 2026
From: Anna Gruber, Student Council
Subject: Survey Results – Student Stress Levels[1]

Introduction[2]
This report presents the findings of a survey on stress levels conducted among 85 students in years 5 and 6. The aim is to identify the main causes of stress and suggest possible measures.[3] The survey was carried out anonymously[4] over a two-week period in February and consisted of ten questions on workload, sleep and support services.

Levels of stress[5]
The majority of respondents (72%)[6] reported feeling stressed on a regular basis. When asked about the timing of stress, students pointed clearly to the weeks before exams. Notably, girls reported higher stress levels than boys[7], although both groups named similar causes.

Main causes[8]
Exams and homework deadlines were identified as[9] the primary sources of pressure. In addition,[10] 45% mentioned sleep problems connected to school-related anxiety. Only 18% were aware of the school's existing counselling services, which means that many students deal with stress on their own.

Recommendations[11]
On the basis of these findings,[12] I would recommend[13] introducing a weekly "no-homework day" and promoting the counselling service through posters and assemblies. It would also be advisable to[14] schedule exams more evenly across the term to reduce pressure peaks. Finally, teachers could coordinate test dates through a shared online calendar so that deadlines do not pile up in the same week.

Conclusion[15]
In summary, stress is widespread among younger students and is closely linked to exams and homework. If these recommendations are put into practice[16], the school could noticeably improve both student wellbeing and academic results.

WHAT THE EXAMINER NOTICES IN THIS MODEL

The numbers match the marked passages in the model text.

1. **Header – Date, From, Subject all required**: *"Date: 15 March 2026 From: Anna Gruber, Student Council Subject: Survey Results – Student Stress Levels"*
2. **Section heading**: *"Introduction"*
3. **States purpose of report**: *"The aim is to identify the main causes of stress and suggest possible measures."*
4. **Passive – objective method**: *"carried out anonymously"*
5. **Heading for content point 1 – meaningful, not numbered**: *"Levels of stress"*
6. **Report language – cite data precisely**: *"The majority of respondents (72%)"*
7. **Precise reporting of data**: *"Notably, girls reported higher stress levels than boys"*

8. **Heading for content point 2**: *“Main causes”*
9. **Passive voice – objective tone**: *“were identified as”*
10. **B2 linking word**: *“In addition,”*
11. **Every section gets its own heading**: *“Recommendations”*
12. **Linking word for report conclusions**: *“On the basis of these findings,”*
13. **Recommendation – required in every report**: *“I would recommend”*
14. **Formal suggestion phrase**: *“It would also be advisable to”*
15. **Conclusion – a short summary, no new facts**: *“Conclusion”*
16. **Conditional – formal close**: *“If these recommendations are put into practice”*

USEFUL PHRASES

Introduction

- As requested, I have prepared a report on…
- The aim of this report is to…
- This report examines/compares…
- The data was collected through…

Presenting data

- Twenty per cent of the people asked…
- The majority of respondents…
- One in five stated that…
- It is generally felt that…
- A large proportion of those interviewed…

Conclusion / Recommendations

- On the basis of these findings,…
- I would therefore recommend/suggest that…
- It would seem that… is the best option.
- In view of this, one can recommend…
- It would also be advisable to…

More online. On the website this text type also has a second model text (“Report on the use of the school library”, ~250 words · formal) and a realistic borderline text with notes on where it loses marks: matura.bernhardgmeiner.com/report/